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### Fishing rod rack

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#### Abstract

Fishing rod racks are disclosed that are configured to receive one or more fishing rods, each rod including a base and a rod blank extending from the base. The racks include an elongated rigid tubular member; a rod base support, configured to receive the base(s), mounted adjacent a first end of the tubular member; and a rod blank support, configured to receive the rod blank(s), mounted on the tubular member spaced from the rod base support.

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## Background/Summary

RELATED APPLICATION (1) This application claims priority from U.S. Patent Application No. 63/304,097, filed Jan. 28, 2022, the entire disclosure of which is incorporated herein by reference.

### BACKGROUND

(1) Storage of fishing rods and reels is crucial to protect them from damage or breakage. Many anglers or groups of anglers carry multiple rods and reels to fishing locations. Often fishing is conducted from a boat either floating down a river, on a lake, or in the ocean. Moving around a small space in a boat can further jeopardize the rods and reels, potentially causing damage or breakage.

(2) It is generally necessary to support the reel end of the rod and some position around the midpoint of the length of the rod blank (the long, thin cylindrical portion of the rod) to reduce the chance of breakage. Very few solutions exist that protect rods on smaller watercraft or while transporting on/in a vehicle. Human-powered boats, such as drift boats, rowboats, white water rafts, canoes, kayaks, and standup paddleboards, are limited in space and are a danger zone for rods. In these crafts, rods are typically stored on the floor, along the vertical walls, set across seats, or on raft tubes, putting them in danger of falling out of the boat, breakage from moving around the boat, or damage by gear shifting within the boat.

(3) While fishing along a river, lake, or ocean bank, the storage of rods is necessary but primarily

unavailable, causing anglers to set the rods on the ground, or prop them against land features such as rocks, trees, shrubs, or vehicles. When unseen, the rods are often damaged by the angler, other unaware people in the area, vehicles, or animals. In this scenario, an angler or group of anglers may have multiple rods that need a safe place to store the rod during lunch or a rest.

(4) Fishing guides are often responsible for multiple rods and their safety while guests are fishing. With a lack of a safe spot for rods, they often use land features, prop them against vehicles, or lay them across boats. Unaware guests can easily damage or break the rods through stepping on them, leaning/sitting on them, closing doors, and other accidents.

(5) There are generally two disciplines of anglers and accompanying fishing equipment, fly rods and spinning rods (also referred to as spin fishing rods). The shape and position of the reel are dissimilar in various types of fly and spin fishing rods. Fly rods are typically much longer than spin fishing rods and have a variety of butt options. Spin fishing rods come in a variety of form factors but typically include a similar geometry.

(6) FIGS. 1-1C depict common form factors for fishing setups. FIG. 1 shows the handle end of a standard fly fishing rod **10**, having a handle **12**, a reel seat **14**, a reel **16**, a butt cap **18**, and a rod blank **20**. Rod blank **20** is much longer than illustrated, typically extending from 5 to 9 feet. The rod blank is often formed of carbon fiber, and is typically very lightweight and thin compared to other types of fishing rods. FIG. 1A shows a fly rod **22** with an extended portion **24** behind the reel called a “fighting-butt,” FIG. 1B shows a two-handed fly rod **26** (often referred to as a spey rod) that has a large extension **28** behind the reel with a large knob-shaped grip-end **29**, and an extended handle **30** in front of the reel **16** for two-handed operations.

(7) FIG. 1C shows a standard spin fishing rod **32**. Rod **32** has a very different type of reel **34** and has a major part of the handle **36** positioned behind the reel. Spin fishing rods come with a variety of reel geometries and shapes not depicted here.

## SUMMARY

(8) Devices are disclosed herein that provide for the capture, storage, and transport of fishing rods and reels. The devices disclosed herein may be configured for transporting rods on/in vehicles, watercraft, stationary storage such as a riverbank, or storing them inside a home or business.

(9) The rod storage device is portable and interchangeable in its orientation, and adaptable to many environments and locations. In some embodiments, the apparatus is positioned vertically and retains the rods and reels in a vertical position; in others, the apparatus can be mounted horizontally for storage in a vehicle or home. The device is compatible with both fly and spin fishing rods/reels.

(10) In one aspect, the disclosure features a fishing rod rack configured to receive one or more fishing rods, each rod including a base and a rod blank extending from the base, the rack comprising an elongated rigid tubular member; a rod base support, configured to receive the base(s), mounted adjacent a first end of the tubular member; and a rod blank support, configured to receive the rod blank(s), mounted on the tubular member spaced from the rod base support.

(11) Some implementations include one or more of the following features.

(12) The rod base support and the rod blank support each extend radially around a circumference of the tubular member. The tubular member is cylindrical. The rod base support is mounted to be removable by a user. The rod base support includes at least one rod base-receiving portion having a through hole configured to receive a fishing rod butt having a first diameter and a floor configured to receive a fishing rod butt having a second, larger diameter. Alternatively, or in addition, the rod base support comprises a mount and at least one wire holster extending radially from the mount, the wire holster having a loop configured to receive a fishing rod butt and support the fishing rod from under a reel. The mount extends radially around the tubular member. The wire holster is configured to be biased towards an open position in which the loop extends generally perpendicular to a longitudinal axis of the tubular member. The proximal ends of the loop are pivotably mounted on the mount in an offset manner so as to create tension in the loop when the loop is deflected away from the open position.

(13) The rod blank support includes at least one rod blank-receiving portion including a resilient gripping member configured to surround a major portion of the circumference of the rod blank and maintain the rod blank in a position in which a longitudinal axis of the rod blank extends generally parallel to a longitudinal axis of the tubular member. The rod blank support includes a housing defining a cavity in which the resilient gripping member is disposed, the housing extending radially around the tubular member and being fixedly mounted thereto and having at least one open area configured to allow the rod blank to be inserted into the gripping member. The rod blank support further includes an outer member mounted radially around the tubular member and over the housing, the outer member being rotatable relative to the housing between an open position, in which the rod blank can be inserted into and removed from the gripping member, and a closed position in which the rod blank is locked in the rod blank support. The rotation of the outer member relative to the housing is limited by stops. The rod blank support further includes detents configured to retain the outer member in the open and closed positions.

(14) The tubular member includes a central cavity configured for storage of a plurality of rod sections. The central cavity is segmented to allow the rod sections to be segregated into groups.

(15) In another aspect, the disclosure features a fishing rod rack comprising (a) an elongated rigid tubular member; and (b) a rod blank support, configured to receive the rod blank(s), mounted on the tubular member, the rod blank support comprising (i) at least one rod blank-receiving portion including a resilient gripping member configured to surround a major portion of the circumference of the rod blank and maintain the rod blank in a position in which a longitudinal axis of the rod blank extends generally perpendicular to a longitudinal axis of the tubular member, and (ii) a housing defining a cavity in which the resilient gripping member is disposed, the housing extending radially around the tubular member and being fixedly mounted thereto and having at least one open area configured to allow the rod blank to be inserted into the gripping member.

(16) Some implementations may include one or more of the following features, as well as any of the features enumerated above.

(17) The rod blank support further includes an outer member mounted radially around the tubular member and over the housing, the outer member being rotatable relative to the housing between an open position, in which the rod blank can be inserted into and removed from the gripping member, and a closed position in which the rod blank is locked in the rod blank support. The rotation of the outer member relative to the housing is limited by stops. The rod blank support further includes detents configured to retain the outer member in the open and closed positions. The gripping members are formed of an elastomeric material or a foam. The gripping members are generally cylindrical and include a slit through which the rod blank can be pressed and a bore into which the rod blank is received, a length of the slit and a longitudinal axis of the bore extending generally parallel to a longitudinal axis of the tubular member. The tubular member is cylindrical.

(18) The disclosure also features methods of using the racks disclosed herein. For example, the disclosure features a method of storing a fishing rod having a base and a rod blank extending from the base that includes (a) providing a fishing rod rack comprising (i) an elongated rigid tubular member; (ii) a rod base support, configured to receive the base(s), mounted adjacent a first end of the tubular member; and (iii) a rod blank support, configured to receive the rod blank(s), mounted on the tubular member spaced from the rod base support; (b) inserting the base of the rod into the rod base support; and (c) inserting a portion of the rod blank into the rod blank support.

(19) Some implementations of the method may further include locking the rod blank in place in the rod blank support, and/or removing rod sections from the rod blank and storing the rod sections in a central cavity of the tubular member.

(20) Within this specification embodiments have been described in a way which enables a clear and concise specification to be written, but it is intended and will be appreciated that embodiments may be variously combined or separated without parting from the invention. For example, it will be

appreciated that all preferred features described herein are applicable to all aspects of the invention described herein.

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## Description

### DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1 is a perspective view of a fly fishing rod.
- (2) FIG. 1A is a perspective view of a fly rod with an extended portion behind the reel.
- (3) FIG. 1B is a perspective view of a spey rod.
- (4) FIG. 1C is a perspective view of a standard spin fishing rod.
- (5) FIG. 2 is a perspective view showing a fishing rod rack according to one implementation.
- (6) FIG. 3 is a perspective view of the rack of FIG. 2 with three fishing rods in place.
- (7) FIG. 4 is an enlarged perspective view showing an upper portion of the rack shown in FIG. 2 in an open position.
- (8) FIG. 4A is an exploded perspective view of the upper portion of the rack.
- (9) FIG. 4B is similar to FIG. 4A but taken from below.
- (10) FIG. 4C is an exploded perspective view of the upper portion of a rack according to an alternative embodiment in which the detent slots are on the surface rather than around the perimeter.
- (11) FIG. 5 is similar to FIG. 4 but shows the upper portion in a closed position.
- (12) FIG. 6 is a top view of the upper portion of the rack in the closed position.
- (13) FIG. 7 is an enlarged perspective view of a lower portion of the rack with a rod in place.
- (14) FIG. 7A is a side view of the lower portion of the rack taken looking along the diameter of the reel towards the rod handle.
- (15) FIG. 7B is a cross-sectional view of the lower portion of the rack and the rod handle taken along line B-B in FIG. 7A.
- (16) FIG. 8 is an enlarged perspective view of the lower portion of the rack with a different type of rod (fighting butt) in place.
- (17) FIG. 9 is an enlarged perspective view of the lower portion of the rack with several different types of rods in place.
- (18) FIG. 9A is a bottom planar view of the arrangement shown in FIG. 9.
- (19) FIG. 10 is an enlarged perspective view showing a lower portion according to an alternative embodiment in which the handle end of the rod is supported by a wire holster, with a rod in place.
- (20) FIG. 11 is a perspective view of the lower portion shown in FIG. 10.
- (21) FIG. 12 is an enlarged perspective view of the lower portion shown in FIGS. 10 and 11, with the lower portion supporting a spin fishing rod.
- (22) FIG. 13 is an enlarged perspective view of the upper portion of the rack, showing a central portion in use storing rod segments.
- (23) FIG. 14 is a perspective view showing a rack and ground stake exploded.
- (24) FIG. 14A shows the rack and ground stake of FIG. 14 assembled.
- (25) FIG. 15 is a perspective view of a rack assembled with a wall mount.
- (26) FIG. 16 is a perspective view of a rack assembled with a flat mount.
- (27) FIG. 17 is a perspective view of a rack mounted on a tube frame of a raft.
- (28) FIG. 18 is an enlarged perspective view showing a lower portion according to an alternative embodiment in which the handle end of the rod is supported by a loop of cord.

### DETAILED DESCRIPTION

- (29) Referring to FIG. 2, a fishing rod rack **40** according to one implementation includes an upper portion **42**, a lower portion **44**, and a cylindrical support **46** on which the upper and lower portions are mounted such that they extend radially around the cylindrical support. Fishing rods, generally

with their reels in place as shown, insert into the rack in a radial pattern around the central structure. The radial nature of the retention provides space savings and allows a plurality of rods to be stored safely together in a single rack.

(30) The upper portion **42** is configured to support the rod blanks of fishing rods while the lower portion **44** is configured to support the handle ends, as shown in FIG. 3. The cylindrical support **46** provides a rigid support for the upper and lower portion, protects the lengths of the rod blanks, and is in the form of a hollow tube to provide a segmented chamber **48** for safe storage for additional rod sections (see also FIG. 13). Removal of the additional rod sections allows a relatively shorter portion of rod blank to extend beyond the upper portion **42** and thus protects the fragile smaller diameter sections of the rod.

(31) The upper portion **42** is shown in detail in FIGS. 4-6. The upper portion **42** includes a hollow disc-shaped outer member **50** having a plurality (four in the implementation shown) of L-shaped (when seen from above) open areas **52** that have openings at the perimeter of member **50** to receive the rod blanks **20** of fishing poles to be mounted in the rack. Member **50** also includes a central opening **54** to allow it to be mounted on the cylindrical support **46**. The member **50** slides onto the cylindrical support and is rotatable relative thereto.

(32) Referring to FIGS. 4A and 4B, the upper portion **42** also includes an inner ring member **55** disposed within the hollow interior of the disc-shaped member **50** when assembled as shown in FIG. 4. Inner ring member **55** is fixedly mounted on the cylindrical support **46**, e.g., by clamping it in place with screw **47** (FIG. 4A), such that the outer member **50** can rotate about the inner ring member **55**. Inner ring member **55** includes slots **56** (FIG. 4B) radially spaced to correspond to the positions of the open areas **52** on the member **50**. When the member **50** is rotated relative to the inner ring member **55**, the leg portion **57** adjacent each opening **52** occludes or partly occludes the openings of slots **56** as shown in FIG. 6. The closure of the slots **56** by the leg portions **57** serves to securely lock the rod blanks in place in the upper portion **42** as shown in FIG. 5. The member **50** would rotate freely about member **55** but its rotational movement is limited by screws **58** which are fixedly attached (e.g., by threaded attachment, as shown) to the inner ring member **55** such that interaction of the two ends of grooves **60** with the shafts of the screws **58** serves as a stop. The engagement of the heads of the screws **58** with the upper surface of the member **50** also serves to attach the member **50** to the ring member **55**. Referring to FIG. 4B, a pair of spring-loaded balls **51A** (only one of which is visible) on the outer circumferential surface of the ring member **55** are configured to selectively engage slots **53** on the inner surface of side wall **49**, acting as detents to releasably hold the ring member **55** in the open and closed positions of the upper portion **42**. As shown in FIG. 4A, a second set of balls **51B** is provided on the top surface of the inner ring member **55**. These balls **51B** engage a second set of detent slots **53B**, positioned on an under surface of member **50** (FIG. 4C).

(33) The upper portion **42** can include both sets of balls/slots or just one set or the other, depending on the degree of engagement desired. The second set **51B/53B** may be easier to manufacture.

(34) As shown in FIG. 4A, the upper portion **42** also includes grippers **61** that fit inside cavities **62** in the inner ring member **55**. Grippers **61** are of a resilient material, e.g., an elastomeric material or a foam, and serve to surround and protect the rod blank. Each gripper **61** includes a central bore **64** for holding the rod blank, and a slit **66** to allow the rod blank to be pushed into the central bore. The bore **64** is sufficiently smaller in diameter than the rod blank **20** to provide a small interference between the elastomeric material and the rod blank, creating enhanced friction to retain the blank **20** when the locking ring **50** is in the open position. The soft, resilient nature of the grippers also damps the vibration of the rods, e.g., during the rocking and jostling of a vehicle or watercraft.

(35) Referring now to FIGS. 7-8, the lower portion **44** of the rack is in the form of a ring member **70** that is fixedly attached to the cylindrical support **46**, e.g., by clamping it onto the cylindrical support **46** using a screw (not shown) that extends across open area **72** (FIG. 7). The ring member **70** includes a plurality of handle supporting areas **74** that are aligned radially with the slots of ring

member **55** of the upper portion **42** when the rack is assembled. Each handle supporting area **74** includes a through hole **76** and a floor area **78** surrounding the through hole **76**. A side wall **80** extends vertically from the periphery of the floor area **78**, forming a generally cylindrical cavity. The floor area **78** also defines a rim **82** at the perimeter of the ring member **70**.

(36) In use, a standard fly rod **10** such as that shown in FIG. **1** can be inserted into the rack such that its butt **11** extends into through hole **76** and reel **16** is supported by rim **82**. The rim **82** catches behind the reel and engages the reel diameter, preventing the rod from rotating. Cylindrical support **46** extends behind handle **12** and stabilizes the handle end of the rod in the rack. Alternatively, as shown in FIG. **8**, a rod **22** with an extended “fighting butt” portion **24** can be supported on the rack by placing the portion **24** in the cavity defined by floor area **78**, rather than having the butt extend through the through hole **78**. The side wall **80** contains the butt and minimizes lateral movement. FIGS. **9** and **9A** show a variety of different types of rods all being supported by the lower portion **44**.

(37) FIGS. **10-12** show an alternative type of lower portion, that may be used instead of or in addition to the lower portion **44** described above. In this embodiment, a ring member **90** includes a plurality of generally U-shaped wire holsters **92** that are configured to receive the butt of a fishing rod and then support the rod from below the reel **16** as shown in FIG. **10**. This embodiment is particularly useful for holding larger-butt fly rods such as spey rods (FIG. **10**) and spin fishing rods (FIG. **12**). However, the holsters accommodate any rod/reel combination, including the smallest traditional rods, the largest Spey rods, and traditional spin fishing rods.

(38) The proximal ends of holsters **92** are pivotably mounted in holes **89** of the ring member **90**, so that the loop of each holster is movable between an “open” (maximum area for rod insertion) position in which the loop is substantially perpendicular to the longitudinal axis of the cylindrical support **46**, and a “closed” position, in which the loop is deflected downward towards the outer surface of the cylindrical support. The holsters are configured to spring back to their normal, “open” position when they are not being held down by a user or by the force of the reel of a rod inserted in the holster (or a rod blank extending adjacent the holster if the butt of the rod is being supported by the lower portion **44**). Referring to FIG. **11**, this return force is provided by having the legs **91A**, **91B** of the holster be of different lengths and the holes **89** in which they are mounted being offset. This offset causes the wire of the loop to deform and be in tension when flexed downward towards the closed position, in the same manner as the wire gate of a wire gate carabiner. When the downward force is released the tension in the wire causes the holster to return to its normal, open position, allowing the holster to be ready for rod insertion.

(39) The angles and geometry of the wire loop center the reel and engage the reel diameter when in the bottom position, preventing the rod from excessively rotating.

(40) Each of the holsters **92** includes a roller **96** at its distal end. Roller **96** rotates freely on the wire, facilitating the insertion of the rod and reducing friction during insertion to protect the rod surface. The roller **96** also, by having a larger diameter than the wire, creates a larger engagement surface to protect the reel when the rod is in place in the rack. In some implementations the roller is formed of a material that is softer than the wire, e.g., Nylon or other thermoplastic material. The ring member **90** includes arcuate surfaces **93** (FIG. **11**) that are configured to receive and support the rod handle, as can be seen in FIGS. **10** and **12**.

(41) Referring to FIG. **11**, the ring member **90** includes a clamp portion **94**, to allow it to be removably attached to the cylindrical support **46**. Because both ring member **90** and ring member **70** are releasably clamped onto the cylindrical support **46** either one can be used independently of the other. Also, because the holsters **92** are pivotably mounted on the ring member **90** they can be bypassed by pressing them downward toward the cylindrical support **46** when not in use. (The presence of the rod blanks of rods supported by the lower portion **44** will overcome the relatively low return force of the loops hold the holsters in place in the stowed position.)

(42) Referring to FIG. **13**, as noted above the cylindrical support **46** includes a segmented bore **48**

for storage of rod sections. The bore includes walls **100** that define four wedge-shaped chambers, to protect the rod sections and keep the rod sections for different rods separated.

(43) FIGS. **14-16** show different mounting arrangements for the rack **40**. When outdoor storage is desired, the rack can be mounted vertically using a ground stake **102**, as shown in FIGS. **14-14A**. For indoor storage, e.g., in a garage, the rack can be mounted on a wall mount **104** (FIG. **15**) or a flat mount **106** (FIG. **16**). The wall mount **104** or flat mount **106** can be used to mount the rack in an aluminum boat or the roof of a pickup canopy. The rack can also be clamped to the tube frame of a raft or to the roof rack of a vehicle using commercially available fittings. For example, as shown in FIG. **17** the lower end of the cylindrical support **46** can be threaded into a fitting **110** (e.g., an NRS LoPro™ Frame Fitting) which can then be releasably clamped to a tubular frame member **112** of the tube frame of a raft **114**.

## OTHER EMBODIMENTS

(44) A number of embodiments have been described. Nevertheless, it will be understood that various modifications may be made without departing from the spirit and scope of the disclosure.

(45) For example, while the upper portion **42** is shown as being flush with the top edge of the cylindrical support **46**, the upper portion **42** can be clamped lower on the cylindrical support **46** if desired, such that the cylindrical support **46** extends beyond the upper portion **42**.

(46) Moreover, while it is preferred that the upper portion **42** include the outer member **50** to provide the locking functionality described above, in some implementations the outer member **50** can be omitted and the grippers **61** be used to retain the rods, alone or in combination with a strap (not shown), e.g. an elastomeric Voile Strap®, wrapped around the perimeter of the ring member **55**. In such implementations it may be desirable to adhere the bottom surfaces of the grippers **61** to the facing surfaces of cavities **64** if the compression of the resilient material in the cavity is not sufficient to hold the grippers **61** securely in place.

(47) Alternatively, while it is desirable to include the grippers **61** to protect and cushion the rod blanks and assist in holding them in place, in implementations that include the outer member **50** to lock the rod blanks in place the grippers **61** could be omitted. If the grippers are not used other measures may be taken to protect the rod blanks, for example the rod blank-receiving areas may be sized to relatively closely fit the rod blank to minimize lateral movement and/or the inner ring member **55** may be made entirely of a resilient material.

(48) If desired, a surface, e.g., the inner surface, of the upper end of the cylindrical support **46** may be threaded, to receive a threaded cap (not shown) similar to a fly rod tube. The threaded surface may also be utilized to attach other components, e.g., extensions of the cylindrical support **46** or accessories such as a camera mount or drying rack, to the upper end of the cylindrical support.

(49) While it is generally preferred that the cylindrical support be cylindrical (round in cross-section), an elongated support having a desired cross-section (e.g., elliptical, square, rectangular, etc.) may be used and the geometry of the support-facing surfaces of the ring members **55**, **70** and **90** adjusted to conform to the geometry of the outer surface of the elongated support. The term “tubular member”, as used herein, refers collectively to elongated supports regardless of cross-sectional shape.

(50) In addition, instead of the U-shaped wire holsters **92** shown in FIG. **10**, as shown in FIG. **18** the lower portion **44** can include a plurality of loops **192** of cord or rope **193** enclosed in a flexible sleeve of polymeric tubing **195**. This embodiment would be suitable, for example, for holding spey rods.

(51) In some implementations, the rack may be configured to carry more or fewer rods than shown in the drawings, for example from 2 to 6 rods.

(52) Accordingly, other embodiments are within the scope of the following claims.

## Claims

1. A fishing rod rack configured to receive one or more fishing rods, each rod including a base and a rod blank extending from the base, the rack comprising: an elongated rigid tubular member; a rod base support, configured to receive the one or more bases, mounted adjacent a first end of the tubular member; and a rod blank support, configured to receive the one or more rod blanks, mounted on the tubular member spaced from the rod base support, the rod blank support comprising (a) at least one rod blank-receiving portion including a resilient gripping member configured to surround a major portion of the circumference of the rod blank and maintain the rod blank in a position in which a longitudinal axis of the rod blank extends parallel to a longitudinal axis of the tubular member; (b) a housing defining a cavity in which the resilient gripping member is disposed, the housing extending radially around the tubular member and being fixedly mounted thereto and having at least one open area configured to allow the rod blank to be inserted into the gripping member; and (c) an outer member mounted radially around the tubular member and over the housing, the outer member being rotatable relative to the housing between an open position, in which the rod blank can be inserted into and removed from the gripping member, and a closed position in which the rod blank is locked in the rod blank support.
2. The rack of claim 1 wherein the rod base support and the rod blank support each extend radially around a circumference of the tubular member.
3. The rack of claim 2 wherein the tubular member is cylindrical.
4. The rack of claim 1 wherein the rod base support includes at least one rod base-receiving portion having a through hole configured to receive a fishing rod butt having a first diameter and a floor configured to receive a fishing rod butt having a second, larger diameter.
5. The rack of claim 1 wherein the rotation of the outer member relative to the housing is limited by stops.
6. The rack of claim 1 further comprising detents configured to retain the outer member in the open and closed positions.
7. The rack of claim 1 wherein the rod base support is mounted to be removable by a user.
8. The rack of claim 1 wherein the rod base support comprises a mount and at least one wire holster extending radially from the mount, the wire holster having a loop configured to receive a fishing rod butt and support the fishing rod from under a reel.
9. The rack of claim 8 wherein the mount extends radially around the tubular member.
10. The rack of claim 8 wherein the wire holster is configured to be biased towards an open position in which the loop extends generally perpendicular to a longitudinal axis of the tubular member.
11. The rack of claim 10 wherein the proximal ends of the loop are pivotably mounted on the mount in an offset manner so as to create tension in the loop when the loop is deflected away from the open position.
12. The rack of claim 1 wherein the tubular member includes a central cavity configured for storage of a plurality of rod sections.
13. The rack of claim 12 wherein the central cavity is segmented to allow the rod sections to be segregated into groups.
14. The rack of claim 1 wherein the gripping member is formed of an elastomeric member or a foam.
15. The rack of claim 14 wherein the gripping member is generally cylindrical and includes a slit through which the rod blank can be pressed, and a bore into which the rod blank is received, a length of the slit and a longitudinal axis of the bore extending generally parallel to a longitudinal axis of the tubular member.
16. A method of storing one or more fishing rods, each rod having a base and a rod blank extending from the base, the method comprising providing a fishing rod rack comprising (a) an elongated rigid tubular member; (b) a rod base support, configured to receive the one or more bases, mounted

adjacent a first end of the tubular member; and (c) a rod blank support, configured to receive the one or more rod blanks, mounted on the tubular member spaced from the rod base support the rod blank support comprising (a) at least one rod blank-receiving portion including a resilient gripping member configured to surround a major portion of the circumference of the rod blank and maintain the rod blank in a position in which a longitudinal axis of the rod blank extends parallel to a longitudinal axis of the tubular member; (b) a housing defining a cavity in which the resilient gripping member is disposed, the housing extending radially around the tubular member and being fixedly mounted thereto and having at least one open area configured to allow the rod blank to be inserted into the gripping member; and (c) an outer member mounted radially around the tubular member and over the housing, the outer member being rotatable relative to the housing between an open position, in which the rod blank can be inserted into and removed from the gripping member, and a closed position in which the rod blank is locked in the rod blank support; inserting the base of the rod into the rod base support; and inserting a portion of the rod blank into the rod blank support.

17. The method of claim 16 further comprising locking the rod blank in place in the rod blank support.

18. The method of claim 16 further comprising removing rod sections from the rod blank and storing the rod sections in a central cavity of the tubular member.

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